

SW Engineering CSC648-848 Fall 2025

GatorsMatch Tutors

Team 01

Milestone 3 Summary

Meeting Date: 11/17/2025 @ 4:30pm

Feedback on UI:

- Search button on the home page requires an extra step that can be tedious to a user. Search flow is advised to require fewer clicks.
- Some dropdown menus are visually mismatched in sizes.
- When filters (e.g MATH -> 256 -> ZOOM) are selected, the system refreshes quickly or resets unexpectedly. The feedback was to avoid premature or double refreshes and instead update results only when needed/necessary.
- Dynamic Truncation was suggested. For example, after a user narrows filters (chooses math) subsequent options should shrink to relevant ones.
- The tutor dashboard bottom row (pagination 1 2 3) should align evenly across the page. Nitpicky but just for visual pleasure.
- Font choice and layout clarity was talked about. The heading “Courses I Tutor” currently looks like a divider rather than an “i” therefore we must use a more explicit label.
- Hover animations should only apply to clickable buttons to prevent confusion.

Feedback on Code/Architecture:

- The availability grid for tutors looks cluttered (like a bingo board style). Instead it was suggested we use a simpler row-based layout with day, start time, end time, and modality.
- Consider handling availability as an array of entries, which is easier to process and maintain than multiple input fields.
- Only show or require an availability block after tutor is approved since it can change frequently.
- It was also suggested we incorporate future flexibility. The form could support alternating modalities such as tutors having Mondays on Zoom and Tuesdays In-Person.
- The professor emphasized focusing on workflow clarity and maintainability before adding complexity.

Feedback on Github Usage:

- Team should continue committing frequently and pushing small, clear changes.
- Maintain consistent branch names and pull requests.
- Ensure all teammates can pull the latest version and run the project locally or via the server.
- Keep documentation in the repo updated after each meeting.

Feedback on DataBase

- No major structural issues noted, but the professor hinted that once we begin backend expansion then we must plan remaining features carefully to prevent schema drift.
- Test the search filters for any unnecessary queries that could cause the extra DB refreshes.
- Validate relationships between User -> TutorApplication -> Tutor to ensure consistency after approval or rejection.

Feedback on Teamwork and Risk Management:

- Two dashboards remain: Tutor dashboard and Admin dashboard.
- Begin backend implementation while front-end members refine UI
- Plan for at least one round of message functionality before milestone 4.
- Encouraged strong task planning and clear division of roles going forward as it can get messier as more work gets done.
- Risk Reminder: if the EC2 server crashes run htop first to check resource usage since its often due to RAM or CPU limits. Or just contact him before resetting it.

Agreed upon P1 Features for Final Delivery:

1. Search Functionality

- Streamline the home page search to reduce user clicks
- Fix refresh behavior when multiple filters are applied to prevent double refreshes.
- Implement dynamic truncation. Narrowing filters should progressively refine remaining options

2. Tutor Dashboard

- Display all tutors with clean pagination alignment.
- Ensure consistent layout, spacing and fonts. Update the Courses I Tutor label.
- Only include availability section for approved tutors.
- Redesign the availability grid to a row based system rather than the bingo board grid.

3. Admin Dashboard

- Approve/reject apps with clear status indicators.
- Display summary counts (pending, approved, rejected).
- Provide streamlined controls for promoting users to tutors or admins.

4. Authentication and Roles

- Maintain working login/signup for users and tutors with @sfsu.edu validation.
- Ensure role based access control works across all views.

5. Messaging Functionality

- Implement at least one round of message exchange between tutor and student.

6. Database Integrity

- Ensure stable relationships between User, TutorApplication, and Tutor tables.
- Verify approved apps update tutor listings correctly.

7. UI/UX Enhancements

- Match dropdown sizes and button hover states.
- Improve responsiveness across mobile and desktop.

8. Server Stability and Deployment

- Ensure the Flask app runs reliably on AWS EC2 using Gunicorn and Nginx.
- Use http to monitor resources to prevent server crashes.

Architecture review confirmed – MVC structure, naming, and comments verified OK.

Additional Comments/Issues: None at this time